

MARCUS AURELIUS

Meditations

translated by George Long
c. 180

COMMONPLACE · READ 2026-08

Read in the Long translation, which is stiffer than Hays but keeps the sentence rhythm of a man writing notes to himself rather than for a reader.

*The universe is change; our life
is what our thoughts make it.*

— Book IV, 3

1 SEPTEMBER 2026

The second clause is the one that survives contact with a bad week. The first is the premise it rests on — if nothing holds still, then the only fixed point available is the *stance* you take, not the thing you take it towards.
